

Turning Consumer Evidence into a Stronger Business Case for Glass Packaging

Consumer intelligence GPI can use to influence packaging decisions, protect demand and strengthen the business case for glass.



CLIENT

Glass Packaging
Institute



RESEARCH BASE

4,046
U.S. adults



FIELDWORK

May 28–
June 14, 2026



DELIVERABLE

73-page
strategic report

“

EcoFocus gave us more than data. They gave us a credible, consumer-backed story that we and our members can use in conversations with brands, policymakers and the marketplace.

— Scott DeFife, President, Glass Packaging Institute

The Challenge

The Glass Packaging Institute needed more than a collection of favorable statistics. It needed a repeatable consumer measurement system that could help members influence real packaging decisions, support public communications and reinforce glass as a premium, trusted choice.

GPI wanted biennial research that would answer practical questions: Do consumers still prefer glass in key categories? How much does packaging influence purchase behavior? What happens when brands move from glass to plastic or cans? Which audiences are most receptive, and what messages are most likely to move them?



What GPI Needed the Research to Do



Deliver credible consumer evidence members could use with brand partners.



Demonstrate the role of glass in health, quality, trust and environmental responsibility.



Quantify loyalty and switching risk when brands move away from glass.



Identify priority audiences, categories and communications channels.



Create an ongoing source of PR, thought leadership and member-facing content.

The EcoFocus Approach

EcoFocus worked with GPI to translate its strategic messaging priorities into a research framework. Rather than testing disconnected questions, the study was designed so each section could generate proof points for member conversations, brand outreach, communications and policy engagement.

Research Component	How It Added Value
 Longitudinal tracking	Built on EcoFocus research conducted since 2010, allowing GPI to distinguish enduring preferences from emerging shifts.
 Custom GPI questions	Measured brand associations, switching behavior, natural/organic expectations and the role of packaging in recent purchases.
 Action-oriented analysis	Converted findings into audience priorities, category opportunities, ready-to-use talking points and communications recommendations.



Methodology

Nationally representative online survey of U.S. adults age 18+ | n=4,046 | Balanced to the U.S. Census | Margin of error +/-1.55%

What the Research Revealed

The study transformed broad support for glass into specific commercial arguments that members could use with brands and decision-makers.



59%

say glass is the only food and beverage packaging where they do not have to worry about chemicals.



64%

wish more food and beverages were available in glass.



49%

would leave a preferred brand entirely if it switched from glass to plastic.



42%

of packaging-influenced shoppers were specifically looking for glass — the most sought material tested.

From Findings to Strategy



Health is the strongest entry point:

Health reasons influence purchase decisions more consistently than environmental reasons. The report recommended leading with safety, chemical reassurance and healthier packaging before broader sustainability language.



The risk of leaving glass is measurable:

Changing packaging is not simply a procurement decision. It can expose brands to customer loss, demands for lower prices and weakened trust.



Audience targeting should follow behavior:

Frequent organic food and functional beverage buyers emerged as especially receptive audiences. Their shopping behavior proved more predictive than demographics alone.



Communication must match the audience:

Social media was identified as the strongest channel for reaching frequent organic and functional beverage buyers and younger consumers, while packaging and labels remained especially important among older consumers.

“ The final report connected consumer attitudes to business decisions. It showed where glass already has an advantage, where that advantage is vulnerable and where GPI and its members can act. **”**

BUILT FOR ACTIVATION

The Deliverable: A Research Report

EcoFocus delivered a 73-page report that combined consumer data, trend analysis, subgroup analysis, category implications, communications guidance and ready-to-use business language. The report was organized to serve both researchers and non-research stakeholders.



Deliverable Element	Business Use
 Nine themed chapters	Moved from chemical safety and packaging preferences through brand risk, audience targeting and strategic recommendations.
 Trend and generational views	Shown where glass preference is stable, where it is softening and where younger buyers differ.
 Behavior-based audience analysis	Identified organic, functional beverage and jarred-food buyers as priority audiences.
 Ready-to-use talking points	Translated data into language for marketing, procurement, packaging, R&D and executive conversations.
 Full data appendix	Provided question wording, subgroup detail and significance testing for research credibility and future reuse.

Examples of Activation-Ready Language

59% of consumers say they dislike buying beverages in plastic bottles specifically because a better option isn't offered to them. This is a supply decision, not a demand problem, and your next packaging spec can solve it directly.

Switching this product away from glass puts nearly half your customers (49%) at risk of leaving the brand entirely. Another 18% would only stay at a lower price. This is a two-thirds-of-your-base decision, not a cost decision.

Brands using glass are seen as more environmentally responsible (40%), higher quality (35%), and more trustworthy (32%) than plastic-using brands.

The Value Created for GPI

The project gave GPI a common evidence base that could support member conversations, public communications and future research.

It also reframed the role of consumer research: not as a backward-looking scorecard, but as a practical tool for protecting demand, identifying growth opportunities and improving the effectiveness of industry messaging.



Credibility

Nationally representative data gave GPI and its members independent evidence for claims about consumer preference, trust and purchase behavior.



Commercial relevance

The report quantified brand-switching risk, unmet demand and target audiences, connecting consumer attitudes directly to business decisions.



Communications utility

Each chapter concluded with practical takeaways, and the business-case section provided language ready for presentations, memos, outreach and media.



Long-term intelligence

The biennial framework creates a barometer GPI can use to track change, refresh its narrative and keep member conversations current.



EcoFocus understood that our members did not need another academic report. We needed defensible evidence, clear implications and language that could be used immediately. The team delivered all three.

Why EcoFocus

EcoFocus combines nationally representative consumer research with deep sustainability and packaging expertise. That combination allows the team to do more than report percentages. EcoFocus helps clients understand what the data means, how it connects to the market and how to turn it into better decisions and stronger communications.



Sustainability-focused consumer research conducted since 2010.



Custom questions integrated with a broad syndicated evidence base.



Research design tied directly to business and communications objectives.



Clear interpretation for marketing, insights, packaging, procurement and executive audiences.



Deliverables designed to be reused across sales, communications and member engagement.



Turn sustainability intelligence into market advantage.
Talk with EcoFocus about the business questions you need to answer.

EcoFocus Research | Consumer insight. Market context. Clear action.

Source: EcoFocus Research 2026 Syndicated Study, Consumer Attitudes & Behaviors on Glass Packaging, prepared for the Glass Packaging Institute.